I want You to Come with Me

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General Audiences

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F/F

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationship:
Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Adora & Catra (She-Ra)

Character:
Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra), Glimmer (She-Ra), Bow (She-Ra), Horde Soldiers (She-Ra)

Additional Tags:
Alternate Universe - Canon Divergence, Character Study, POV Catra (She-Ra), Adora is in Love with Catra (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra) Needs a Hug, Lesbian Catra (She-Ra), Lesbian Adora (She-Ra), Pining Catra (She-Ra), Poor Catra (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra) Redemption, Catra Leaves the Horde (She-Ra), POV Female Character, Character Development, Slow Burn, Slow Romance, Friends to Lovers, Best Friends, Friendship, Emotional Hurt/Comfort, Hurt/Comfort, Angst and Hurt/Comfort, Light Angst, Angst with a Happy Ending, Fluff and Angst, Catra is Bad at Feelings (She-Ra), Adora/Catra is Canon (She-Ra), I Will Go Down With This Ship

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I want You to Come with Me

by Little_Miss_Sunflower

Summary

"Catra, wait!" Adora called. "Please?"

She stopped running, whirling around to face her. "Wait for what, Princess Adora? For you to show me your new tiara up close and personal? No thanks."

Adora slowed to a stop in front of Catra. She was breathing hard and barely able to stand up right. "Don't be ridiculous, Catra, I just want—"

"Your tiara is the only thing being ridiculous right now."

Or, the one where Adora chased after Catra at the end of episode 1x02 "The Sword part 2."

Notes

This was just kind of a character study for Catra and what was going through her head during the scene during the battle in Thaymor, but with a "what if" ending tagged on to it. This is my first time writing anything for She-Ra, so I hope I did the characters the justice they deserve.

I had a lot of fun writing this piece, and would absolutely be open to writing a little bit more AU for it if people would be interested! So, leave a comment and let me know if you'd like to see a little more!

Kudos and reviews are always appreciated! :)

***Some dialogue lifted straight from the episode. I take no creative license for those lines and all rights belong to the

shows creators.***

Chapter 1

For some reason, Shadow Weaver had sent her on Adora's mission to Thaymor in the hopes of finding the Hordes newest force captain. Something about Catra knowing Adora best and how Adora may have gone to Thaymor to complete her first mission, blah blah blah. And sure, she wanted to find Adora too, she was her best friend after all, but she never thought that finding her would be as easy as plowing a tank through a civilian village. Adora was was clever, she would never do something as stupid as throw herself into the pathway of an oncoming 63-ton-tank unprotected and vulnerable. But somehow, there she was—arms spread wide and stubbornly staring down the metal spike at the front of the tank. Catra stopped the tank so fast she was fairly certain she broke something, flung the overhead door opened, and jumped out onto the roof.

"Adora!"

"Catra?"

She didn't even think, didn't question why Adora was there or why she was trying to stop the tank. Catra jumped from the hatch and landed on her friend, knocking her to the ground. If anybody claimed she was purring, she would absolutely deny it later.

"They let me drive a tank! Can you believe it?"

"Catra, I don't understand. Why are you here?"

"Uh, duh, we came to find you," she said as she stood, taking Adora's wrist and helping her up.

"'Cover for me Catra. No one will even know I'm gone,'" Catra said, mimicking her friend. "Seriously, did you just immediately get captured right after you snuck out or—What are you wearing?"

She pointed at the pink flower tucked behind her friends' ear. Come on, a flower? It was stupid. Flowers wilted and died, and besides, the hair poof Adora insisted on having already looked silly enough. She didn't need the flower's help for that. Her Adora would *never* wear something as dumb as a pink flower in her hair. But she'd be lying if she didn't admit, at least to herself, that Adora did look cute wearing the dumb thing. And the pout on her face as she took the flower out of her hair and tossed it on the ground behind her? Even cuter.

"Look, there's no time," Adora said. "We have to put a stop to this."

"What? Why?"

"Because this is a civilian town. Look around! These aren't insurgents, they're innocent people!"

Catra turned away from Adora. She always was about as stubborn as a Horde tank. How did she not see that Catra was trying to help her? As if she would *ever* leave her friend behind at the mercy of the princesses. And she did *not* want to face Shadow Weaver's wrath if she came home without the new force captain—Adora had always been Shadow Weavers favorite, after all.

"Yeah, sure. Innocent people who kidnapped a Horde officer," she said, taking Adora by the wrist and leading her back towards the tank. "Now come on, let's get you back to the Fright Zone. Shadow Weaver is *freaking out.* It'd be funny if she weren't such a terrible person."

Adora pulled her hand back. "Catra, no. I can't go back. Not until the Horde leaves this town alone. You have to help me!"

Catra looked over her shoulder, trying to keep the hurt away from her voice. She knew she was failing, as surely as she knew where this conversation was going, and she hated it. "What are you saying?"

“I’m saying this is wrong,” Adora said. They’ve been lying to us, manipulating us. Hordak, Shadow Weaver, all of them.”

“Duh! You just figured that out? Manipulation is Shadow Weaver’s whole thing! She’s been messing with our heads since we were kids.”

“How could you be okay with that?”

Adora looked so heartbroken that Catra softened her approach. She couldn’t lose her; she’d never forgive herself if she pushed Adora away. Through their whole lives it had always been the two of them, watching each other's backs. She couldn’t bear the thought of losing a friendship like that.

“Because. It doesn’t matter what they do. The two of us look out for each other,” Catra said, placing her hands on Adora’s shoulders. “And soon we’ll be the ones calling the shots. Now come on. Can we go home already?”

That was the moment one of the nearby Horde tanks fired a shot, and a new burst of flames erupted beside them. Adora flinched, one of the civilians screamed, and Catra saw it in her expression. Catra knew. Adora was always too good for the Horde anyway, if she was being honest. She was a far better person than she ever was, and why Adora ever wanted to be her friend in the first place, Catra would never know. She cared about people, more than anyone else in that nightmare of a place they called home—for lack of a better word. The Fright Zone never felt like a home, not really, in fact Adora was the only thing that ever made the place bearable. It was her home because Adora had been there, always right by her side. But now...

“I’m not going home, Catra. I can’t. Not after everything I’ve seen,” Adora said, taking Catra’s hand in hers. “Come with me. You don’t have to go back there. We can fix this.”

Catra ripped her hand away from Adora’s grasp. “Are you kidding? You’ve known these people for what? A couple of hours? And now

you’re gonna throw everything away for *them* ? What happened to you?”

“I don’t know,” Adora said. “But I have to do something. I’m sorry Catra.”

Catra felt the pain and anger build inside of her. She didn’t know why this felt like such a betrayal. Here Adora was, asking her to come with her, to defect from the Horde. But somehow, the fact that she was so willing to leave, even if Catra didn’t come, that she was choosing to go with these strangers over her—over the people they grew up with—felt like Adora was choosing these strangers over her. She swore she wouldn’t return to the Fright Zone without Adora, and here Adora was ready to leave her—she was leaving her. If Catra hadn’t shown up, would Adora have ever tried to contact her, or would she just carry on and start a new life without her? For the briefest moment, something inside of Catra snapped. As Adora turned her back to her and began to leave her behind, she grabbed her taser gun, pressed the metal prongs to Adora’s back, and pressed the trigger button. Adora yelled in pain and dropped to the ground—Catra immediately regretted it.

“Oh man! That was a lot stronger than I thought,” Catra said. “Are you okay?”

Adora struggled to right herself back up. She made it as far as a sitting position when she said Catra’s name, and on impulse she shocked her friend again eliciting another yell. Seriously, what was wrong with her? She hadn’t meant to shock her the second time, and she honestly didn’t realize how strong the first shot would be. The Horde really should start putting some type of intensity setting on these things. But of course, they didn’t, because they were the Horde. Pain was their game after all. And that was what they had trained her for. The Horde and Shadow Weaver had trained her to react, to inflict pain on others before they could inflict it on her.

“I’m sorry!” she said, watching as Adora collapsed again from pain. “It was a reflex.”

"W—why are you doing this?"

How did Adora always manage to do that? To pull all of Catra's anger out of her body without even trying. She looked so hurt, laying there looking up at her, probably feeling as betrayed as Catra felt. That was currently her problem though. Without her anger, all Catra had left was the sensation of betrayal, the deeply rooted pain in her chest, and a far too familiar ache at the back of her throat that told her tears wouldn't be far behind.

"Because you left me. And if I don't bring you back Shadow Weaver is gonna have my head. So, enough with your weird little identity crisis and let's go home already. Or do I need to zap you again?"

Catra did not want to zap her friend for a third time, and she doubted she had the anger left inside of her for it anyway. Not that she would get to find out, because the words had barely left her mouth when she got a face full of pink sparkles. She shrieked and batted them away, but by time her vision cleared again, some *princess* was knelt down beside Adora and a guy with his abs exposed riding on some kind of animal fired a net from his bow—*with an arrow?* —pinning her to the ground and entangling her. Catra aimed her taser gun at the princess and fired, but in the time it took for Arrow Boy to call for them to watch out, both Adora and the princess disappeared in a cloud of pink glitter and the electricity hit the dirt where they had been.

She called for her friend, yelling Adora's name desperate to have her back. She would *not* lose Adora. She couldn't. Did that *dumb sparkly princess* really think she could just steal Catra's best friend? Her anger poured back into her and she growled, breaking the ropes as she got back up. Sparkles might not be here to claw, so Arrow Boy would have to do. She pounced, grabbing onto him and knocking him back off of his weird animal and slamming him to the ground— *hard.*

He dropped his bow and it looked like he was out of arrows, which made this easy. He managed to grab his bow before she landed

on him, feet first, not that it did him much good. Arrow Boy was using his bow to try to block her, but she pressed down on it with all of her strength. Something inside Catra had snapped and she could feel it. These people, these *strangers* , had stolen Adora away from her, the only person she had ever really had in her life that she could rely on. Arrow Boy managed to get a good kick in and toss her through the air. Catra hit the ground with a scream, rolling herself back to her feet within seconds. She turned to see him trying to make a run for it, but the Horde-bots and tanks were already closing in around him. Murder wasn't something she was keen to put on her list of accomplishments, she was content to just rough him up a little, something to let her frustrations out on. But if the Horde wanted to kill him, she didn't exactly have the rank to pull to be able to stop them, so she turned away, not wanting to witness the poor idiot get blasted out of existence.

As she was turning, she saw a light appear off to the side. It was way too bright to be anything the Horde had concocted, and she had never seen anything like it before. It was moving towards the center of the Horde's circle to where Arrow Boy was standing. She squinted, trying to focus on the light, and saw her. An eight-foot-tall blond woman in a tiara. *Another princess* . Was this one of Adora's new best friends too? She growled in frustration and began inching forward, closer to the circle for a better look. This new princess moved to stand just in front of Arrow Boy, and without saying a word she hefted her sword and slammed it point first into the rocky ground at her feet. The earth responded by knocking nearly all of the Horde soldiers, bots, and tanks over as it shifted and trembled. In fact, the only part of the earth that stood still was the small circle where the princess and Arrow Boy were standing.

The few Horde soldiers, bots, and tanks that remained didn't stay that way long. As Sparkles ran back to join her little boyfriend, the new princess demolished what was left of her squads' machinery, and the soldiers turned and ran screaming. The Horde should probably train those morons better before sending them out next time—if they even got a next time. Catra reached the bottom of the ruble and watched as the princess took a step toward her

friends, the light faded, and she dropped to her knee. As soon as she hit the ground though, the princess with the stupid tiara wasn't the one leaning against the sword—it was Adora. The air around them was filled with smoke and dirt from the broken machines and the earth tremors, but for a moment, Catra stood there staring at Adora. She couldn't think, she couldn't act. She felt nothing and everything all at once. It was as if her whole world had stopped turning while spinning impossibly faster at the same time. It was only for a few seconds, and then the smoke began to clear and Adora looked up and locked eyes with her.

"Catra."

Adora's voice was soft, and she sounded guilty, almost. It was the way she spoke whenever she was about to apologize, or whenever she was consoling Catra after Shadow Weaver had punished her. Something in her voice made her unfreeze. She couldn't survive an apology right now. She was too broken right now. She had to get away. Catra turned and ran, just like her cowardly squad had done, and truthfully, she was no better than them. She didn't make it very far before she heard another set of footsteps running behind her—very slow, familiar footsteps.

"Catra, wait!" Adora called. "Please?"

She stopped running, whirling around to face her. "Wait for what, *Princess Adora* ? For you to show me your new tiara up close and personal? No thanks."

Adora slowed to a stop in front of Catra. She was breathing hard and barely able to stand up right. "Don't be ridiculous, Catra, I just want—"

"Your tiara is the only thing being ridiculous right now."

"Catra, I'm serious. Please?"

"Fine!" she snapped, gesturing with her hand to continue. "What do you want, *princess* ?"

Adora sighed and took a step closer. “I’m sorry, I didn’t know about that before today, I swear.”

“I don’t want your dumb apology, Adora, so if that’s why you chased after me, then you wasted your time. Go back to your new friends before you fall over.”

“I’m not going to fall over. And why do you always have to be so difficult?”

“Somebody has to challenge you, since you're so perfect at everything!”

“Why are you acting like this?”

“Because you left me!” Catra screamed. A flock of birds took off in a nearby tree. Adora froze. At least she had the floor now. “ *You left me, Adora.* You were just going to defect from the Horde and leave me behind. And now, I’m going to be all alone.”

“Catra, I—”

“Don’t say you're sorry, Adora. I don’t need your apology. Just go back to your new *best friends.”*

Catra hated crying. Crying was a weakness, and she should never let anybody know or see her cry if she did. That was Shadow Weaver’s favorite thing to tell her when she was a kid, and up until now, Adora was the only person she never felt weak crying in front of. But now, having Adora see her cry seemed like the biggest weakness she could possibly display, so she turned to leave before the tears could spill over and roll down her face. She’d only taken a single step when Adora’s hand caught hers, effectively stopping her from taking a second step.

“You’re right, Catra. I was going to defect from the Horde.”

“Great,” she said bitterly, her back still to Adora. “Glad we cleared that up. Can I go now?”

“No, that’s not what I want.”

“Then what do you what?”

“I want you to come with me, Catra.”

She gave a breathy laugh that blended with the choked sob in the back of her throat. “Why would you want me to come with you? You have new *princess friends* now, don’t you?”

“But they aren’t you, Catra,” Adora said. “You’re still my best friend. I need you.”

“You didn’t need me to take out those Horde tanks, or soldiers, or bots,” Catra said, turning around to face her. “You did that on your own, just fine. You didn’t need me to defect from the Horde. You were just fine to do that on your own too.”

“I was going to defect from the Horde. But leaving you behind? Catra that was the hardest part of that decision. And when I saw you get out of that tank, I was so glad that you were here, because it meant that I had a chance to ask you to come with me.” Adora took Catra’s other hand in hers and took another step closer.

“I can’t be a part of what the Horde is doing—attacking civilian towns like this? I won’t help them do that. But that doesn’t mean I wanted to leave you. You and I have always had each other’s backs. We look out for one another. So much has changed for me today, and my whole world has been turned upside down. I need my best friend, Catra, I need you.”

“I zapped you with the taser gun twice today, Adora,” Catra said with a half smirk. “You really sure that’s best friend material?”

Adora laughed. It was a soft laugh, and Catra noticed that Adora was crying too. Looks like they were both weak by the Horde’s standards.

“I’m sure,” she said.

“You know they’ll probably lock us up as soon as we set foot in Bright Moon, right?”

“Glimmer won’t let that happen.”

“Oh, is that Sparkles’ real name?”

“Does this mean you’re coming with me?” Adora asked.

“You know, I think I liked Sparkles better...” she said, teasing her.

“Are you coming with me or not?”

“Let me guess, Arrow Boy is called something equally as obvious?”

“His name is Bow.” Adora said in defense, then her eyes widened as she seemed to realize the irony of it.

Catra laughed. “Course it is.”

“Catra!” she laughed

“Of course, I’m coming,” she said. “If you can’t see how obvious of a name Bow is for a guy who shoots a bow and arrows, you clearly need me more than either of us realized."

Chapter 2

Chapter Summary

> So, obviously I decided I wanted to write a little more for this story. So... leave a comment and let me know what you think!
>
> As always, Kudos and Comments are appreciated! :)

When they came back to the clearing, Sparkles had two fists of glitter aimed at her. Arrow Boy seemed to momentarily forget that he was out of arrows and reached to pull one from his quiver, grabbing on to nothing but the dust filled air instead. He settled for gripping his bow in both hands as if it were a club.

"Seriously?" Catra laughed. "These two are the best the rebellion has to offer? How haven't we beaten them yet?"

Princess Sparkles— *Glimmer* , apparently—made an indignant huff and a pink ball of glitter flew towards Catra. This time, she managed to duck in time to avoid it.

"What is she doing here?" Glimmer said.

Bow pushed his empty weapon out in front of him like a barrier. "She tried to kill me!"

"I can see how you got that impression," she said with a shrug. "I was just blowing off a little steam. Try not to take it so personal."

To her left, Adora sighed and pinched the bridge of her nose.

"Catra, that's not helping," Adora said. "Bow, Glimmer, this is my best friend Catra."

"And she's still here because...?" Bow asked.

"Because, she's coming back with us."

Arrow Boy dropped his bow and Sparkles glitter fist fizzled out. They both stood there, frozen like a pair of statues, empty hands still holding their battle positions, eyes wide and jaws dropped. Adora folded her arms and waited for them to recover, and Catra covered her mouth to hold back her laughter. Their reactions were too perfect. In unison, they broke out of their daze.

"I can't bring a Horde soldier back to Bright Moon!"

"She tried to kill me!"

"And, I'm sure that she's really sorry," Adora said, and turned to look at her. "Aren't you, Catra?"

It was posed as a question, but Adora's intent was clear. If Catra wanted to go with them, to preserve a friendship with Adora, there was only one answer she could give. Catra had sworn she'd never apologize to anyone for anything, and a voice in the back of her mind told her that to admit to guilt would be to show weakness. But this wasn't just anyone asking, it was Adora, and that voice in her mind sounded far too much like Shadow Weaver for her taste. It had been silent for too long, she guessed, because Adora raised a brow at her, and the message was clear enough— *you have to actually say it, Catra.*

"Right, I'm sorry," she said, then returned her friends gesture, silently asking her approval— *was that good enough for you, Adora?*

"Right," Bow said, "Because that was believable."

"Well, I'm sorry if apologizing is a new experience for me, okay? We didn't all get to grow up in a magical forest with glittery princesses."

"Catra," Adora said. "You have to actually try."

"What? That was a genuine apology."

"I meant you have to actually *try to be nice to them.* "

Catra rolled her eyes. “It’s a work in progress, okay?”

“Adora, she’s with the Horde,” Bow said. “Glimmer’s right. We can’t bring a Horde soldier back to Bright Moon with us.”

“Maybe you didn’t notice, Arrow Boy, but if I was with the Horde, don’t you think I’d actually *be with the Horde*?”

“Maybe.” He said as he bent down to pick up his weapon. “Or, you could have stayed behind to act as a spy. How can we know we can trust you?”

Catra had no real answer. There was nothing she could ever say that would prove she wasn’t here as a spy. Sure, she could tell these perfect strangers how much Adora meant to her, how Adora was the only thing that ever-made living in the Fright Zone bearable. She could tell them that going back to the Fright Zone meant living in alone and being completely miserable. She could tell them about Shadow Weaver and how manipulative and cruel that horrible woman was. But none of that would erase their doubts, and anything she said would just make her look more suspicious.

She was stupid for not just going back with the rest of the Horde soldiers. They would leave her, Adora would go back with her new friends, and Catra would be abandoned in the ruins of Thaymore with nowhere to go. Catra’s attention was pulled to Glimmer as the princes took a step forward.

Glimmer looked at Adora and met her eyes. “Do you *really* trust her?”

“Absolutely.”

Adora’s response was immediate, followed by a soft smile in Catra’s direction. She felt her cheeks warm. Adora was there for her, and even after she zapped her with an electric rod twice, she trusted her. Catra really didn’t deserve her, but she was glad for her all the same.

“I didn’t trust Adora before, when I should have. And she saved us, and the people of Thaymore. So, I’m choosing to trust her now. But if you do anything to make me doubt, make me think you’re still with the Horde...”

Glimmer took a step towards Catra, standing just a few inches away. She left the threat unspoken, hovering in the air between them. It would have been so easy for her to kick out and knock this princess right off her feet, but she was going to have to stop think like that if she was going to go with these people. Besides, something in the way she was looking at Catra, how she stepped towards her with no hint of fear, made her pause. Glimmer was about half a foot shorter than Catra, the top of her head only coming to her shoulders, but she was determined to protect her people, and she wasn’t afraid to risk her own safety to do it. Catra knew that was the kind of person you did not want as an enemy. Maybe there was more to this princess than just the sparkles.

“Do not make me regret this,” Glimmer said.

“Glad we cleared that up,” Catra said. She made a mental note not to get on Sparkles bad side.

“Well then,” Glimmer said, stepping back. “How are we going to explain bringing a Horde soldier back to my mother? Because she is *really* not going to like this.”

...

By the time they reached the boarder of the Whispering Woods, Catra was about ready to strangle Bow. He spent most of their walk reminding Glimmer how Catra had tried to kill him, and questioning if the princess was sure about letting her come back. The thought of being left in this dumb forest to go back to the Fright Zone alone terrified Catra. If he somehow managed to talk that princess in to changing her mind and they left her behind, she was going to strangle him with his own bow string.

Glimmer had elected to ride the weird animal—a horse, apparently—back to Bright Moon. It seemed this princess had a power limit, and she was just about tapped out of sparkles and energy. She and Bow—who wasn't Glimmer's boyfriend, but Catra could tell he *definitely* wanted to be—took the lead. She followed behind with Adora in silence, both too exhausted from the fight to talk. It was dusk by time they emerged from the woods, and Bow slowed the group down to a stop.

"Hey, we made it!" Bow said.

Catra and Adora moved to stand beside the horse, opposite Bow, and looked out over the city. Beside her she heard Adora's sharp intake of breath, and Catra couldn't blame her. Nobody from the Horde had ever seen Bright Moon in person, the Whispering Woods were too dense and confusing for anyone to make it through. Catra thought that was almost a shame, because the city was stunning.

Glimmer sat up on her horse and smiled, gesturing to the city in front of them. "Welcome to Bright Moon!"

An ivory castle with a golden gilded roof stood on top of a white cliff, with a magnificent waterfall pooling into a lake at the cliff's base. An elegant golden post stood before the castle, with a large shining crystal floating freely above. High stalagmites rose up sporadically from the water around the city, with dozens of ivory colored stone cottages dotting across the hills.

"It's so beautiful," Adora said, smiling.

Birds were chirping all around them, which was a strange sound after the groans and rumbles of the old metal buildings in the Fright Zone. *Beautiful* didn't quite encompass what Catra felt when she looked at this city. Inside the city, it must have been so *peaceful,* and Catra had never felt so deprived of something in her life. She couldn't remember a time she had ever felt peaceful, living under Shadow Weaver's watchful eyes, afraid that she

would round a corner to be scolded by the woman for something she had done wrong again, always a disappointment.

"Okay, I just need to go in there, recharge, and deal with my mom. This'll be fun," Glimmer said. She led her horse forward a few steps and then stopped, turning to look back. "Uh, Bow? Maybe you should take them in the back way?"

…

Apparently, the back way was up the side of a cliff with a rope and through a window. Bow had been the first one inside, and helped both her and Adora in after him.

"Oh, hey, here, why don't you put this robe on!" Bow said.

A flying pink robe hit Adora, covering her head, and a blue one came flying at Catra a second after, which she caught in one hand. Catra got the feeling that the rest of Bright Moon wouldn't be too keen to give a pair of ex-Horde soldiers a warm and happy welcome.

"You're trying to hide us," Adora said, pushing the pink robe off of her face.

Bow put both of his hands up in surrender, looking like he was about to protest the comment, but Catra cut in before he got the chance.

"We're not stupid," she said.

"People of Bright Moon aren't going to be very welcoming to a couple of Horde soldiers, are they?"

Catra crossed her arms and leaned back against the wall. "What are we getting ourselves into here?"

Bow sighed, walked over to the doors, and cracked one opened. He peeked out the narrow gap between them and looked around. "Think pitch forks and torches."

“Well, doesn’t that sound like fun,” she said.

Adora groaned and plopped down onto cushions by one of the windows. She grabbed a pink stuffed animal and looked down at it with a pout, picking at a few of the loose strings on its oversized ears. Catra’s shoulders relaxed and she sat beside her friend, placing a comforting hand on her shoulder.

“It’s just that, people of Bright Moon have been really hurt by the Horde,” Bow said, He closed the door and walked over, kneeling down in front of them. “Everyone here has lost someone in the war. You can’t blame them for being a little suspicious.”

“I’m sorry,” Adora said, and somehow, she managed to look even more hurt than before.

“*I’m* the one who plowed through a civilian village with a tank, Adora. *You’re* the one who tried to stop it. *You* aren’t the one who has something to apologize for.”

Bow nodded. "And once the they get to know you, the people of Bright Moon are going to trust you. Just like Glimmer and I already do.”

“And I always have,” Catra said. “The Horde never deserved you anyway.”

A cloud of pink glitter started to form, and Glimmer appeared in the room behind Bow, who screamed in surprise. Catra laughed as he struggled to compose himself and act natural. Adora smiled, glancing at Catra with an expression that read, “w*e will never let him forget this.”*

“I’m here!” Glimmer announced. Either she hadn’t noticed Bow scream, or he did that so often she was used to it. “My mom’s on her way, but no one panic.”

Catra leaned back into the cushions that really had no business being that comfortable. “Great. Do you want to throw me in prison now, or should I wait for her to get here?”

Everyone turned their attention to Catra.

“What?” she asked. “You said nobody panic.”

“Catra, nobody is going to arrest you,” Adora said, then looked to Glimmer for confirmation.

“My mom may try at first,” Glimmer admitted before rushing on. “But I won’t let her! I made you both a promise and I intend to keep it.”

“Alright, princess. Then what exactly is the plan?”

“I was thinking we start by introducing her to She-Ra!”

“Wait, we’re jumping straight to She-Ra with your mom?” Bow asked. “Are you sure?”

“I can’t believe I’m saying this, but I second Arrow Boy’s question,” Catra said. She stood and took a deliberate step between Adora and Sparkles.

“Oh, yeah, sure, because *‘hey mom, we found a pair of Horde soldiers, can we keep them?’* would be a great first introduction,” Glimmer said. “She’d be furious. And you’d both be prisoners of Bright Moon, no matter what I said. But my mom is going to *love* She-Ra. We can ease her into the Horde stuff later.”

Catra turned to her friend. “Adora, it’s your call. I’m positive we can figure out another solution if you don’t want to do this."

“I don’t know if I can just turn on, She-Ra like that, I've only done it when someone was in danger before. And it felt a little out of control last time. I’m still figuring out how all of this stuff works”

Catra snored. “A little? You rearranged the ground back in Thaymore.”

“See?” Adora said, gesturing to Catra. “Out of control. Point proven.”

“Isn’t that all the more reason to practice though?” Glimmer asked.

“Maybe,” Catra said, “But that doesn’t have to be right this minute. We can figure something else out with your mom.”

“I guess it couldn’t hurt to give the She-Ra plan a quick try first?” Adora said.

Before anyone could say anything, she snatched the sword up off the floor. Adora started to say whatever the stupid little phrase was, but she only managed to make it about as far as *“for the honor”* when her new sword got caught in banner fabric hanging from the ceiling. She tried to tear the sword through the rest of the way, but tripped over the discarded blue robe Catra had tossed aside earlier and fell back into one of the shelves, taking out a handful of glass bottles and trinkets with her. She dove to the ground, somehow catching every breakable trinket, laid them beside her, and roll to her back with a groan.

Bow and Glimmer stood to one side, most likely trying to figure out the best course of action for how to respond, and she stood on the other. Catra reacted first, laughing, and as Bow and Glimmer helped Adora up, they joined her.

“Yeah, I don’t think this She-Ra plan of yours is going to work out, Sparkles,” Catra said. “As we just saw, apparently, it can hurt."

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